

**Climate Change in the American Mind: National Survey Data on Public Opinion (2008-2024)**  
**Survey Methods and Codebook**  
**August 2026**

**Survey Methods**

Data are based on 33 waves of nationally representative surveys of U.S. adults aged 18 and older. As shown in Table 1, surveys were conducted once in 2008 and then twice a year from 2010 to 2025. All questionnaires were self-administered by respondents in a web-based environment. The questions included in this dataset represent a small portion of those asked in the complete surveys.

Samples were drawn from the Ipsos KnowledgePanel®, an online panel of members drawn using probability sampling methods. Prospective members were recruited using a combination of random digit dial and address-based sampling techniques that cover virtually all (non-institutional) resident phone numbers and addresses in the United States. Those contacted who chose to join the panel but did not have access to the Internet were loaned computers and given Internet access so they could participate. The sample therefore includes a representative cross-section of American adults – irrespective of whether they had Internet access, used only a cell phone, etc.

**Table 1. Sample Details by Wave**

| Wave           | N     | Dates Fielded                       |
|----------------|-------|-------------------------------------|
| November 2008  | 2,164 | October 7 – November 12             |
| January 2010   | 1,001 | December 24, 2009 – January 3, 2010 |
| June 2010      | 1,024 | May 14 – June 1                     |
| May 2011       | 1,010 | April 23 – May 12                   |
| November 2011  | 1,000 | October 20 – November 16            |
| March 2012     | 1,008 | March 12 – March 30                 |
| September 2012 | 1,061 | August 31 – September 12            |
| April 2013     | 1,045 | April 10 – 15                       |
| November 2013  | 830   | November 23 – December 9            |
| April 2014     | 1,013 | April 15 – 22                       |
| October 2014   | 1,275 | October 17 – 28                     |
| March 2015     | 1,263 | February 27 – March 10              |
| October 2015   | 1,330 | September 30 – October 19           |
| March 2016     | 1,204 | March 18 – 31                       |
| November 2016  | 1,226 | November 18 – December 1            |
| May 2017       | 1,266 | May 18 – June 6                     |
| October 2017   | 1,304 | October 20 – November 1             |
| March 2018     | 1,278 | March 7 – 24                        |
| December 2018  | 1,114 | November 28 – December 11           |
| April 2019     | 1,291 | March 29 – April 8                  |
| November 2019  | 1,303 | November 8 – 20                     |
| April 2020     | 1,029 | April 7 – 17                        |

|                       |        |                   |
|-----------------------|--------|-------------------|
| December 2020         | 1,036  | December 3 – 16   |
| March 2021            | 1,037  | March 18 – 29     |
| September 2021        | 1,006  | September 10 – 20 |
| April 2022            | 1,018  | April 13 – May 2  |
| December 2022         | 1,085  | December 2 – 12   |
| April 2023            | 1,011  | April 18 – May 1  |
| October 2023          | 1,033  | October 20 – 26   |
| April 2024            | 1,031  | April 25 – May 4  |
| December 2024         | 1,013  | December 11 – 22  |
| May 2025              | 1,040  | May 1 – 12        |
| December 2025         | 1,146  | November 6 – 14   |
| Total out of 33 waves | 37,495 | --                |

### Sampling Error

All samples are subject to some degree of sampling error – that is, statistical results obtained from a sample can be expected to differ somewhat from results that would be obtained if every member of the target population were interviewed. The margin for error for each wave is plus or minus 3 percentage points at the 95% confidence level, except November 2008 where the margin of error is plus or minus 2 percentage points. Margins of error become smaller when combining multiple waves for analysis (e.g., the margin of error for each year is typically plus or minus 2 percentage points). Margins of error become larger when examining smaller subgroups of the population (e.g., political party).

### Rounding Procedure

Percentage points are rounded to the nearest whole number or decimal place. As a result, percentages in a given chart may total slightly higher or lower than 100%. Summed response categories (e.g., "strongly agree" + "somewhat agree") are rounded after sums are calculated (e.g., 1.3% + 1.3% = 2.6%, which, after rounding = 3%). Also, percentages below 0.50% were rounded down and those that were 0.50% or above were rounded up (e.g., after rounding, 2.49% = 2% and 2.51% = 3%).

### Sampling Weights

Once the surveys were fielded and all survey data were collected, sampling weights were computed for each respondent. Data were weighted based on key demographic variables to match U.S. Census Bureau norms. Data from the Current Population Survey (CPS), the American Community Survey (ACS), and/or demographic profile data from the Knowledge Panel® of U.S. adults age 18 or older were used as benchmarks for the raking adjustment of weights. Data were typically weighted by respondents' age, gender, race/ethnicity, Census region, metropolitan status, education, and income.

There are two weight variables in the dataset. The variable "weight\_wave" refers to the

sampling weights that were computed for each wave of data collection. Because sample sizes vary from wave to wave, we computed a “weight\_aggregate” variable that standardizes the sampling weights so data can be analyzed at an aggregate level (i.e., combining waves of data), adjusting for sample size differences across waves. We computed “weight\_aggregate” by (1) dividing the “weight\_wave” variable by the sample size of each respective wave, and then (2) by multiplying these values by the average sample size of all 33 waves (total  $N = 37,495 / 33$  waves = 1,136) so that the total weighted sample size of the entire dataset equals the unweighted sample size ( $N = 37,495$ ).

Sampling weights should be applied for all descriptive analyses. We advise using the “weight\_wave” sampling weight when conducting descriptive analyses for a specific wave and the “weight\_aggregate” sampling weight when aggregating multiple waves (e.g., across years). To obtain accurate frequencies or counts ( $n$ ), sampling weights need to be turned off.

### **Running Crosstabs with SPSS**

In SPSS, the default when analyzing data using crosstabs is to round cell counts. However, sampling weights can make cell counts nonintegers (i.e., frequencies that are no longer whole numbers). When running crosstabs in SPSS, make sure there are no adjustments to noninteger weights (in the Crosstabs menu, click the Cells button, and select the option that says “No adjustments” beneath “Noninteger weights”).

### **Refusals and Descriptive Analyses**

Respondents were not required to answer all questions in the survey. For every question, refusals were coded as -1 (see below for codebook). For descriptive analyses, refusals should always be considered as valid responses when reporting percentages. For example, if 5% of the sample refused to answer the question, the other responses should sum to 95%.

### **Recommended Citation**

Please cite the dataset and article in any work that makes use of the data and documentation as follows:

Yale Program on Climate Change Communication (YPCCC) & George Mason University Center for Climate Change Communication (Mason 4C) (2026). *Climate Change in the American Mind: National survey data on public opinion (2008-2025)* [Data file and codebook]. doi: [10.17605/OSF.IO/JW79P](https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/JW79P)

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## Climate Change in the American Mind (2008-2025) Codebook

The following tables include information on the variable names in the dataset, survey questions and response options, and the number of waves the questions were included in. The response options for many questions can be collapsed into single categories. For example, for measuring how worried respondents are about global warming “very worried” and “somewhat worried” can be combined into a single measure of “worried.” For more information on computing these categories, visit the [Climate Change in the American Mind \(CCAM\) Explorer](#) and/or download our SPSS syntax on our [Open Science Framework](#) page.

| Variable Name | Survey Question | Response Options                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Included in Waves       |
|---------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| case_ID       | Case identifier | --                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| wave          | Survey wave     | 1. Nov 2008                      27. Dec 2022<br>2. Jan 2010                      28. Apr 2023<br>3. Jun 2010                      29. Oct 2023<br>4. May 2011                      30. Apr 2024<br>5. Nov 2011                      31. Dec 2024<br>6. Mar 2012                      32. May 2025<br>7. Sep 2012                      33. Dec 2025<br>8. Apr 2013<br>9. Nov 2013<br>10. Apr 2014<br>11. Oct 2014<br>12. Mar 2015<br>13. Oct 2015<br>14. Mar 2016<br>15. Nov 2016<br>16. May 2017<br>17. Oct 2017<br>18. Mar 2018<br>19. Dec 2018<br>20. Apr 2019<br>21. Nov 2019<br>22. Apr 2020<br>23. Dec 2020<br>24. Mar 2021<br>25. Sep 2021<br>26. Apr 2022 | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                         |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| year             | Year of wave                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 1. 2008<br>2. 2010<br>3. 2011<br>4. 2012<br>5. 2013<br>6. 2014<br>7. 2015<br>8. 2016<br>9. 2017<br>10. 2018<br>11. 2019<br>12. 2020<br>13. 2021<br>14. 2022<br>15. 2023<br>16. 2024<br>17. 2025 | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| weight_wave      | Sampling weight specific to each wave                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | --                                                                                                                                                                                              | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| weight_aggregate | Sampling weight if aggregating multiple waves                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | --                                                                                                                                                                                              | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| happening        | Recently, you may have noticed that global warming has been getting some attention in the news. Global warming refers to the idea that the world's average temperature has been increasing over the past 150 years, may be increasing more in the future, and that the world's climate may change as a result. What do you think: Do you think that global warming is happening? | -1. Refused<br>1. No<br>2. Don't know<br>3. Yes                                                                                                                                                 | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |

|                  |                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                 |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| cause_original   | Assuming global warming is happening, do you think it is...                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>-1. Refused</li> <li>1. Caused mostly by human activities</li> <li>2. Caused mostly by natural changes in the environment</li> <li>3. Other (Please specify)</li> <li>4. None of the above because global warming isn't happening</li> </ul>                                                                   | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| cause_other_text | [Other - Specify] Assuming global warming is happening, do you think it is...              | Open-ended responses to the "cause_original" question were coded to form a new variable: "cause_recoded"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| cause_recoded    | Assuming global warming is happening, do you think it is... (Recoded to include open-ends) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>-1. Refused</li> <li>1. Don't know</li> <li>2. Other</li> <li>3. None of the above, because global warming isn't happening</li> <li>4. Caused mostly by natural changes in the environment</li> <li>5. Caused by human activities and natural changes</li> <li>6. Caused mostly by human activities</li> </ul> | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| sci_consensus    | Which comes closest to your own view?                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>-1. Refused</li> <li>1. Don't know enough to say</li> <li>2. There is a lot of disagreement among scientists about whether or not global warming is happening</li> <li>3. Most scientists think global warming is not happening</li> <li>4. Most scientists think global warming is happening</li> </ul>       | 32 waves<br>Not asked in Oct 2015<br>N = 36,165 |

|                     |                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                              |                                                 |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| worry               | How worried are you about global warming?                                                                                                     | -1. Refused<br>1. Not at all worried<br>2. Not very worried<br>3. Somewhat worried<br>4. Very worried        | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| harm_personally     | [The following five risk perception questions were asked together as a set]<br>How much do you think global warming will harm: You personally | -1. Refused<br>0. Don't know<br>1. Not at all<br>2. Only a little<br>3. A moderate amount<br>4. A great deal | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| harm_US             | How much do you think global warming will harm: People in the United States                                                                   | -1. Refused<br>0. Don't know<br>1. Not at all<br>2. Only a little<br>3. A moderate amount<br>4. A great deal | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| harm_dev_countries  | How much do you think global warming will harm: People in developing countries                                                                | -1. Refused<br>0. Don't know<br>1. Not at all<br>2. Only a little<br>3. A moderate amount<br>4. A great deal | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| harm_future_gen     | How much do you think global warming will harm: Future generations of people                                                                  | -1. Refused<br>0. Don't know<br>1. Not at all<br>2. Only a little<br>3. A moderate amount<br>4. A great deal | All waves<br>N = 37,495                         |
| harm_plants_animals | How much do you think global warming will harm: Plant and animal species                                                                      | -1. Refused<br>0. Don't know<br>1. Not at all<br>2. Only a little<br>3. A moderate amount<br>4. A great deal | 32 waves<br>Not asked in Oct 2015<br>N = 36,165 |

|                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| when_harm_US      | When do you think global warming will start to harm people in the United States?                                                                                                                                                                            | -1. Refused<br>1. Never<br>2. In 100 years<br>3. In 50 years<br>4. In 25 years<br>5. In 10 years<br>6. They are being harmed right now | All waves<br><i>N</i> = 37,495                                                                                               |
| reg_CO2_pollutant | How much do you support or oppose the following policies?<br><br>Regulate carbon dioxide (the primary greenhouse gas) as a pollutant.                                                                                                                       | -1. Refused<br>1. Strongly oppose<br>2. Somewhat oppose<br>3. Somewhat support<br>4. Strongly support                                  | 31 waves<br>Not asked in May 2011 and Oct 2023<br><i>N</i> = 35,452                                                          |
| reg_utilities     | How much do you support or oppose the following policies?<br><br>Require electric utilities to produce at least 20% of their electricity from wind, solar, or other renewable energy sources, even if it costs the average household an extra \$100 a year. | -1. Refused<br>1. Strongly oppose<br>2. Somewhat oppose<br>3. Somewhat support<br>4. Strongly support                                  | 18 waves<br>Not asked in Oct 2015, Mar and Nov 2016, and May 2017 waves, and was last asked in Apr 2020<br><i>N</i> = 21,013 |

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fund_research      | <p>How much do you support or oppose the following policies?</p> <p>Fund more research into renewable energy sources, such as solar and wind power.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <p>-1. Refused</p> <p>1. Strongly oppose</p> <p>2. Somewhat oppose</p> <p>3. Somewhat support</p> <p>4. Strongly support</p> | <p>31 waves</p> <p>Not asked in Oct 2023</p> <p><i>N</i> = 35,431</p>                                                                                                                                                                |
| reg_coal_emissions | <p>How much do you support or oppose the following policy?</p> <p>Set strict carbon dioxide emission limits on existing coal-fired power plants to reduce global warming and improve public health. Power plants would have to reduce their emissions and/or invest in renewable energy and energy efficiency. The cost of electricity to consumers and companies would likely increase.</p> | <p>-1. Refused</p> <p>1. Strongly oppose</p> <p>2. Somewhat oppose</p> <p>3. Somewhat support</p> <p>4. Strongly support</p> | <p>14 waves</p> <p>Not asked between 2008 to 2012 and asked only to half of the sample (<i>n</i> = 421) in Nov 2013. Also not asked in Nov 2019, Apr 2020, and Dec 2020, and was last asked in Mar 2021</p> <p><i>N</i> = 15,646</p> |
| reduce_tax         | <p>How much do you support or oppose the following policies?</p> <p>Require fossil fuel companies to pay a carbon tax and use the money to reduce other taxes (such as income tax) by an equal amount.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                   | <p>-1. Refused</p> <p>1. Strongly oppose</p> <p>2. Somewhat oppose</p> <p>3. Somewhat support</p> <p>4. Strongly support</p> | <p>18 waves</p> <p>Not asked between 2008 and Mar 2015. Also not asked in Apr 2024. Last asked Dec 2024.</p> <p><i>N</i> = 20,584</p>                                                                                                |

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| priority_cleanenergy | Do you think that developing sources of clean energy should be a low, medium, high, or very high priority for the president and Congress?                                            | -1. Refused<br>1. Low<br>2. Medium<br>3. High<br>4. Very high                                         | 31 waves<br>Not asked in 2008, Nov 2013, or Apr 2014<br><i>N</i> = 33,488                                                                                         |
| generate_renewable   | How much do you support or oppose the following policies?<br><br>Generate renewable energy (solar and wind) on public land in the U.S.                                               | -1. Refused<br>1. Strongly oppose<br>2. Somewhat oppose<br>3. Somewhat support<br>4. Strongly support | 13 waves<br>Not asked until Mar 2016. Also not asked in May 2017, Dec 2018, Apr 2019, Mar 2021, Sep 2021, and Apr 2023.<br><i>N</i> = 14,542                      |
| teach_gw             | How much do you agree or disagree with the following statements?<br><br>Schools should teach our children about the causes, consequences, and potential solutions to global warming. | -1. Refused<br>1. Strongly disagree<br>2. Somewhat disagree<br>3. Somewhat agree<br>4. Strongly agree | 15 waves<br>Not asked between Jun 2010 and Oct 2015. Also not asked in 2008, Dec 2018, Apr 2020, Mar 2021, Apr 2022, Apr 2023, and Apr 2024.<br><i>N</i> = 17,232 |

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                             |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| transition_economy | <p>How much do you support or oppose the following policies?</p> <p>Transition the U.S. economy (including electric utilities, transportation, buildings, and industry) from fossil fuels to 100% clean energy by 2050.</p> | <p>-1. Refused</p> <p>1. Strongly oppose</p> <p>2. Somewhat oppose</p> <p>3. Somewhat support</p> <p>4. Strongly support</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <p>11 waves</p> <p>Not asked until Apr 2020</p> <p>N = 11,456</p>                                           |
| discuss_GW         | <p>How often do you discuss global warming with your family and friends?</p>                                                                                                                                                | <p>-1. Refused</p> <p>1. Never</p> <p>2. Rarely</p> <p>3. Occasionally</p> <p>4. Often</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <p>All waves</p> <p>N = 37,495</p>                                                                          |
| hear_GW_media      | <p>About how often do you hear about global warming in the media (TV, movies, radio, newspapers/news websites, magazines, etc.)?</p>                                                                                        | <p>-1. Refused</p> <p>1. Never</p> <p>2. Once a year or less often</p> <p>3. Several times a year</p> <p>4. At least once a month</p> <p>5. At least once a week</p> <p>98. Don't know</p> <p>99. Prefer not to answer</p>                                                                                                                                                                                            | <p>21 waves</p> <p>Not asked until Apr 2014. Not asked in Nov 2016</p> <p>N = 23,838</p>                    |
| affect_weather     | <p>How much, if at all, do you think global warming is affecting weather in the United States?</p>                                                                                                                          | <p>-1. Refused</p> <p>1. Global warming is affecting weather in the United States a lot</p> <p>2. Global warming is affecting weather in the United States some</p> <p>3. Global warming is affecting weather in the United States a little</p> <p>4. Global warming is not affecting weather in the United States</p> <p>5. Global warming isn't happening</p> <p>98. Don't know</p> <p>99. Prefer not to answer</p> | <p>23 waves</p> <p>Not asked until Apr 2013. Not asked between Oct 2014 and Oct 2015.</p> <p>N = 24,217</p> |
| gender             | <p>Are you...?</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <p>1. Male</p> <p>2. Female</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p>All waves</p> <p>N = 37,495</p>                                                                          |

|               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                             |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| age           | How old are you?                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Open-ended                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | All waves<br>N = 37,495                     |
| age_category  | Computed based on open-ended response to age                                                                                                                                                                                            | 1. 18-34 years<br>2. 35-54 years<br>3. 55+ years                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | All waves<br>N = 37,495                     |
| generation    | Computed based on respondents' age at the time of data collection. Given that generation is estimated, some respondents may be miscategorized.                                                                                          | 1. Gen Z (1997 or later)<br>2. Millennials (1981 – 1996)<br>3. Generation X (1965 – 1980)<br>4. Baby Boomers (1946 – 1964)<br>5. Silent (1928 – 1945)<br>6. Greatest (Before 1928)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | All waves<br>N = 37,495                     |
| educ          | What is the highest level of school you have completed?                                                                                                                                                                                 | 1. No formal education<br>2. 1 <sup>st</sup> , 2 <sup>nd</sup> , 3 <sup>rd</sup> , or 4 <sup>th</sup> grade<br>3. 5 <sup>th</sup> or 6 <sup>th</sup> grade<br>4. 7 <sup>th</sup> or 8 <sup>th</sup> grade<br>5. 9 <sup>th</sup> grade<br>6. 10 <sup>th</sup> grade<br>7. 11 <sup>th</sup> grade<br>8. 12 <sup>th</sup> grade no diploma<br>9. High school graduate – high school diploma or the equivalent (GED)<br>10. Some college, no degree<br>11. Associate's degree<br>12. Bachelor's degree<br>13. Master's degree<br>14. Professional or doctorate degree | All waves<br>N = 37,495                     |
| educ_category | Responses to "educ" were categorized into four groups: responses 1-8 were coded as "Less than high school", 9 was coded as "High school," 10 and 11 were coded as "Some college," and 12-14 were coded as "Bachelor's degree or higher" | 1. Less than high school<br>2. High school<br>3. Some college<br>4. Bachelor's degree or higher                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | All waves<br>N = 37,495                     |
| income        | We would like to get a better estimate of your total HOUSEHOLD income in the past 12 months                                                                                                                                             | 1. Less than \$5,000<br>2. \$5,000 to \$7,499<br>3. \$7,500 to \$9,999                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | All waves<br>N = 37,495<br>Response options |

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                             |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
|                 | before taxes. Was it...                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 4. \$10,000 to \$12,499<br>5. \$12,500 to \$14,999<br>6. \$15,000 to \$19,999<br>7. \$20,000 to \$24,999<br>8. \$25,000 to \$29,999<br>9. \$30,000 to \$34,999<br>10. \$35,000 to \$39,999<br>11. \$40,000 to \$49,999<br>12. \$50,000 to \$59,999<br>13. \$60,000 to \$74,999<br>14. \$75,000 to \$84,999<br>15. \$85,000 to \$99,999<br>16. \$100,000 to \$124,999<br>17. \$125,000 to \$149,999<br>18. \$150,000 to \$174,999<br>19. \$175,000 to \$199,999 [“\$175,000 or more” Nov 2008 – Mar 2016]<br>20. \$200,000 to \$249,999 [Nov 2016 on]<br>21. \$250,000 or more [Nov 2016 on] | changed from Mar 2016 on to include higher levels of income |
| income_category | Responses to “income” were categorized into the following three groups.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 1. Less than \$50,000<br>2. \$50,000 to \$99,999<br>3. \$100,000 or more                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | All waves<br>N = 37,495                                     |
| race            | Respondents were first asked “Are you Spanish, Hispanic, or Latino?” Respondents who said “Yes” were coded as 4 = “Hispanic.” Following this question, all respondents were asked to “Please choose one or more race(s) that you consider yourself to be” with 6 response options, “White,” “Black or African American,” “American Indian or Alaska Native,” “Asian,” “Native Hawaiian or other Pacific Islander,” or “Some other race.” Respondents who said they were not Spanish, Hispanic, or | 1. White, non-Hispanic<br>2. Black, non-Hispanic<br>3. Other, non-Hispanic<br>4. Hispanic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | All waves<br>N = 37,495                                     |

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                              |                         |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
|                 | <p>Latino to first question and said “White” were coded as 1 = “White, non-Hispanic;” “Black or African American” were coded as 2 = “Black, non-Hispanic;” “American Indian or Alaska Native,” “Asian,” “Native Hawaiian or other Pacific Islander,” or “Some other race” were coded as 3 = “Other, non-Hispanic.”</p> <p>Respondents who said they were not Spanish, Hispanic, or Latino and selected more than one race were also coded as 3 = “Other, non-Hispanic”</p>                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                              |                         |
| ideology        | In general, do you think of yourself as...                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | -1. Refused<br>1. Very liberal<br>2. Somewhat liberal<br>3. Moderate, middle of the road<br>4. Somewhat conservative<br>5. Very conservative | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| party           | Generally speaking, do you think of yourself as a...                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | -1. Refused<br>1. Republican<br>2. Democrat<br>3. Independent<br>4. Other<br>5. No party/not interested in politics                          | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| party_w_leaners | <p>Computed based on responses to “party” and a follow-up question “Do you think of yourself as closer to the...” with four response options, “Republican Party,” “Democratic Party,” “Neither,” or “No response.” Respondents who initially identified as either a Republican or Democrat, as well as those who did not initially identify as “Republican” or “Democrat” but who say they “are closer to” one party or the other (i.e., “leaners”) in the follow-up question were categorized as Republican or Democrat, respectively. The category “Independents” does</p> | -1. Refused<br>1. Republicans<br>2. Democrats<br>3. Independent/Other<br>4. No party/not interested in politics                              | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |

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|                  | not include any of these leaners, only those who chose “Independent” or “Other” to the “party” question.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                    |
| party_x_ideo     | Computed based on responses to the “party_w_leaners” and “ideology” items. Democrats were categorized as “Liberal Democrats” if they said they are “Very” or “Somewhat” liberal, or “Conservative/Moderate Democrats” if they said they are “Moderate, middle of the road” or “Very” or “Somewhat” conservative. Similarly, Republicans who self-reported that they are “Very” or “Somewhat” conservative were categorized as “Conservative Republicans,” whereas those who said they are “Moderate, middle of the road” or “Very” or “Somewhat” liberal were categorized as “Liberal/Moderate Republicans.” The category “Independent (non-leaning)” refers to those categorized as “Independent/Other” in the “party_w_leaners” variable. | -2. No party/not interested in politics<br>-1. Refused<br>1. Liberal Democrat<br>2. Moderate/Conservative Democrat<br>3. Independent (non-leaning)<br>4. Liberal/Moderate Republican<br>5. Conservative Republican | All waves<br>N = 37,495                                                                            |
| registered_voter | Are you registered to vote? [Nov 2008 – Apr 2012]<br>Are you currently registered to vote, or not? [Sep 2012 on]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | -1. Refused<br>1. Registered [“Yes” Nov 2008 – Apr 2012]<br>2. Not registered [“No” Nov 2008 – Apr 2012]<br>3. Don’t know [“Not sure” Nov 2008 – Apr 2012]<br>4. Prefer not to answer [Sep 2012 on]                | All waves<br>N = 37,495<br>Question wording and response options changed from Apr 2012 to Sep 2012 |
| region9          | Computed based on state of residence: New England = CT, MA, ME, NH, RI, VT; Mid-Atlantic = NJ, NY, PA; East-North Central = IL, IN, MI, OH, WI; West-North Central = IA, KS, MN, MO, ND, NE, SD; South Atlantic = DC, DE, FL, GA,                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 1. New England<br>2. Mid-Atlantic<br>3. East-North Central<br>4. West-North Central<br>5. South Atlantic<br>6. East-South Central                                                                                  | All waves<br>N = 37,495                                                                            |

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|                             | MD, NC, SC, VA, WV; East-South Central = AL, KY, MS, TN; West-South Central = AR, LA, OK, TX; Mountain = AZ, CO, ID, MT, NM, NV, UT, WY; Pacific = AK, CA, HI, OR, WA.                                          | 7. West-South Central<br>8. Mountain<br>9. Pacific                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                            |
| region4                     | Computed based on "region9": Northeast = New England, Mid-Atlantic; Midwest = East-North Central, West-North Central; South = South-Atlantic, East-South Central, West-South Central; West = Mountain, Pacific. | 1. Northeast<br>2. Midwest<br>3. South<br>4. West                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | All waves<br>N = 37,495                                                    |
| religion                    | What is your religion?                                                                                                                                                                                          | -1. Refused<br>1. Baptist – any denomination<br>2. Protestant (such as Methodist, Lutheran, Presbyterian, Episcopal)<br>3. Catholic<br>4. Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints (Mormon)<br>5. Jewish<br>6. Muslim<br>7. Hindu<br>8. Buddhist<br>9. Pentecostal<br>10. Eastern Orthodox<br>11. Other Christian<br>12. Other – non-Christian<br>13. Agnostic [Apr 2014 on]<br>14. Atheist [Apr 2014 on]<br>15. None of the above [Apr 2014 on;<br>16. "None" Nov 2008 – Dec 2013] | All waves<br>N = 37,495<br>Response options<br>changed from Apr 2014<br>on |
| religion_other_nonchristian | [Other – non-Christian – specify] What is your religion?                                                                                                                                                        | Open-ended responses to the<br>"religion" question                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | All waves<br>N = 37,495                                                    |
| evangelical                 | Would you describe yourself as "born-again" or evangelical?                                                                                                                                                     | -1. Refused<br>1. Yes<br>2. No<br>3. Don't know                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | All waves<br>N = 37,495                                                    |

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| service_attendance | How often do you attend religious services?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | -1. Refused<br>1. Never<br>2. Once a year or less<br>3. A few times a year<br>4. Once or twice a month<br>5. Once a week<br>6. More than once a week | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| marit_status       | Respondents were first asked "Are you now...?" with response options 1-5. Respondents who indicated they were not "Married" (i.e., responses 2-5) were asked a follow-up, "Are you currently living with a partner to whom you are not married?" Respondents who said "Yes" were coded as 6 = "Living with partner"                              | 1. Married<br>2. Widowed<br>3. Divorced<br>4. Separated<br>5. Never married<br>6. Living with partner                                                | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| employment         | Respondents were asked "Do any of the following currently describe you?" with response options "Working full-time", "Working part-time", and "Not working." Respondents who said "Working full-time" or "Working part-time" were recoded as 1 = "Working," and respondents who said "Not working" were recoded as 2 = "Not working."             | 1. Working<br>2. Not working                                                                                                                         | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| house_head         | Respondents were asked "Is your residence in..." with response options "Your name only," "Your name with someone else's name (jointly owned or rented)," or "Someone else's name only." Respondents who said "Someone else's name only" were coded as 0 = "Not head of household;" the other two responses were coded as 1 = "Head of household" | 1. Not head of household<br>2. Head of household                                                                                                     | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| house_size         | Respondents were asked two questions: "Including yourself, how many people are 18 years of age or older and currently live in your                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Open-ended                                                                                                                                           | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |

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|                  | household at least 50% of the time? Please include unrelated individuals (such as roommates), and also include those now away traveling, away at school, or in a hospital” and “Next, how many people are 17 years of age or younger and currently live in your household at least 50% of the time? If none, enter 0. Include babies and small children.” Responses to these questions were combined to calculate overall household size. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                         |
| house_ages0to1   | Please tell us a little more about the people you share your household with. For each person in your household (up to 10 people), enter their age on their last birthday and indicate if they are male or female. For infants who are less than 1 year old, please enter a 0 for age.                                                                                                                                                     | Open-ended                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| house_ages2to5   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                         |
| house_ages6to12  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                         |
| house_ages13to17 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                         |
| house_ages18plus |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                         |
| house_type       | Which best describes the building where you live?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 1. One-family house detached from any other house<br>2. One-family house attached to one or more houses (such as a condo or townhouse)<br>3. Building with 2 or more apartments<br>4. Other (mobile home, boat, RV, van, etc.) | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |
| house_own        | Are your living quarters...                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 1. Owned by you or someone in your household<br>2. Rented<br>3. Occupied without payment of rent                                                                                                                               | All waves<br>N = 37,495 |